

Research

The reasons for turnover of information systems personnel *

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The study examines the effects of the individual characteristics, job type, role stressors, boundary spanning activities, career outcomes, and job characteristics on the turnover propensity of 464 information systems personnel. Results show that age, organizational level, organizational tenure, job tenure, and number of years in the computer field are negatively correlated with the intention to leave the organization. Education was found to be positively correlated with turnover intentions, and while project leaders are more likely to leave the organization, IS managers are less likely. Results also show that both role stressors (role ambiguity and role conflict) and boundary spanning activities are positively correlated with turnover intentions, and that job involvement, career plateau, promotability, salary, organizational commitment, job satisfaction, satisfaction with progress, promotion, pay, status, and projects are negatively correlated while career opportunity is positively correlated with turnover intentions. Finally, all job characteristics are negatively correlated with turnover intentions. Implications of the results for practice and research are offered.

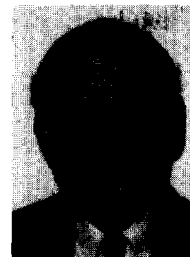
Keywords: Turnover correlates; Retention decisions; Information systems personnel; Organizational commitment; Career decisions; Satisfaction

1. Introduction

Managing the human resources within IS departments is being closely scrutinized in many organizations. One reason is that the cost of IS personnel is high; it consumed an average of 43% of the entire IS departmental budgets in 1988



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